

The divided city

After World War II, the German capital of Berlin was divided in two. The Western half was controlled by the United States, Britain, and France, while the USSR had the Eastern half. The city became the center of the Cold War.

In 1955 the Warsaw Pact was set up as a military alliance between the USSR and six communist countries in Eastern Europe.

The USSR's first intercontinental missile was launched in 1957.

Warsaw Pact

R-7 Semyorka

The USSR tested its first nuclear bomb in 1949.

First Lightning

In 1961, Yuri Gagarin from the USSR became the first man in space.

Yuri Gagarin

China became a communist state in 1949 under Mao Zedong.

Korean War

An attempt by communist North Korea to take over South Korea was stopped by American-led troops between 1950 and 1953.

Chinese Civil War

Vietnam War

Between 1964 and 1975, US troops failed to help South Vietnam beat Communist North Vietnam.

Afghan War

USSR and US soldiers helped different sides in Afghanistan between 1979 and 1989.

The Iron Curtain

The two sides of the Cold War faced each other across an "Iron Curtain" dividing Europe.

AFRICA

The United States and the USSR supported opposing sides in this war between 1975 and 2002.

Angolan War

Close enemies

The United States and the USSR faced each other across the Arctic Circle. At their closest, the countries were separated by only 2.4 miles (3.8 km).



The end of the Cold War

In 1989, communist governments in Europe began to lose control. The Berlin Wall was pulled down in this year, and Germany was united in 1990. The USSR itself collapsed in 1991. The Cold War was over.



The fall of the Berlin Wall